

Kaleab A. Kelkay

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EDUCATION

Bahir Dar University

Bachelor of Engineering in Software Engineering

Bahir Dar, Ethiopia

Jun. 2021 – Jun 2025

EXPERIENCE

Mid-Level Backend Developer

Awura Technologies

Nov 2025 – Present

Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

- Led the backend team in designing and delivering the core P2P financial rotation platform, coordinating architecture decisions and ensuring consistent implementation across the team.
- Engineered a high-performance gRPC API using ConnectRPC and Go, implementing a modular, event-driven architecture to orchestrate real-time P2P payment flows and ledger synchronization.
- Architected an asynchronous notification and state-management system to handle high-concurrency contributions, triggering low-latency payout events upon successful epoch completion.
- Developed a cryptographically secure selection engine utilizing CSPRNG primitives to ensure verifiable fairness and transparency in automated rotating resource allocation cycles.
- Designed a scalable modular monolith for peer-to-peer financial rotation, integrating identity verification and OTP-secured transactions within a strictly typed, event-sourced backend.
- Engineered a real-time bid system using Gorilla WebSocket to stream live bids to connected clients, handling high-concurrency bid submissions and automatically selecting the highest bid upon auction completion.
- Implemented a RESTful API using state machines and event-driven architecture, publishing messages to RabbitMQ for user notifications.
- Implemented a Payment Service that is idempotent and uses eventual consistency to ensure data integrity.
- Designed a reliable and configurable cron job system with dynamic worker pools to process background tasks and perform batched database updates.
- Applied optimistic locking to maintain data consistency and prevent race conditions in concurrent operations.
- Engineered a time-scheduled CMS content lifecycle worker using Asynq to automatically trigger state transitions (activation and expiration) for advertisements and community media based on scheduled start and end timestamps.
- Built an automated referral reward engine and state machine supporting real-time eligibility tracking, claim verification, and administrative fulfillment workflows.
- Engineered automated bot participants and system liquidity actors to dynamically engage in auction bidding and drive continuous round execution.
- Established a containerized testing pipeline leveraging `testcontainers-go` for automated integration testing against ephemeral PostgreSQL and Redis Docker containers.

Fullstack Developer

Alet-Systems (MSA with Lkipay)

Nov 2025 – Feb 2026

Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

- Implemented a robust RESTful API for a gifter mini app on Lkipay, enabling users to send gifts to influencers.
- Designed dynamic worker pools to consume webhook requests from Redis queues and batch database operations, preventing database overload.
- Developed a Golang SDK for seamless Lkipay integration.
- Built a real-time overlay system for OBS and TikTok Studio using WebSockets to display animated overlays when gifts are sent.
- Implemented an admin panel for the gifter mini app within the Lkipay Admin Panel using Next.js, ensuring a smooth administrative experience.

Fullstack Developer

Minab IT Solutions

Jul 2024 – Nov 2024

Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

- Design and implement a robust web-based administration panel that Hahujobs CMS uses.
- Develop an SDK for ArifPay Integration using Golang.
- Integrate Arifpay into the Internal Product.

Backend Intern

Kuraz Technologies

Jun 2024 - Sep 2024

Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

- Develop a Payroll Management System
- Led a team of 6 interns in developing assigned projects under the guidance of an advisor, ensuring successful execution and collaboration throughout the process.

PROJECTS

Mini CDC (Change Data Capture) Engine | *Golang, PostgreSQL, pgx, Kafka* Apr 2026 – Present

- Built a lightweight embeddable CDC engine in Go that streams row-level changes directly from PostgreSQL WAL using logical replication.
- Implemented a replication client using `pglogrepl` to consume and decode WAL events in real time via the `pgoutput` plugin.
- Decoded logical replication output into structured `ChangeEvent` payloads for INSERT, UPDATE, and DELETE operations.
- Designed a modular pipeline with a `PostgresSource`, buffered channel for backpressure, and a `KafkaSink` for downstream event distribution.
- Implemented LSN acknowledgement after sink confirmation to prevent WAL disk bloat and guarantee at-least-once delivery.
- Leveraged replication slots for resume-from-failure semantics, enabling the engine to recover and continue from the last confirmed LSN.
- Handled connection drops with exponential backoff and jitter for long-running replication streams.
- Presented the engine at a company hackathon, receiving interest from the CEO and Head of Engineering.
- Authored a technical blog post detailing the architecture and internals — [Eve Doesn't Poll, She Listens](#).

Payment Gateway Service | *Golang, PostgreSQL, Docker, RabbitMQ, Echo* Dec 2025 – Present

- Built an idempotent payment service using Golang, PostgreSQL, and RabbitMQ.
- Developed RESTful APIs using Go's Echo framework.
- Implemented the `Transactional Outbox Pattern` to handle dual-write consistency and ensure idempotent message publishing.
- Designed dynamic worker pools to process payments asynchronously and deliver results to client webhook endpoints.
- Applied row-level locking to ensure data consistency and prevent race conditions during concurrent transactions.
- Implemented retry queues and dead-letter queues to reliably handle failed payment events.
- Containerized the full development environment using Docker and Docker Compose for consistent and reproducible builds.

Araray | *Node.js, Express, TypeScript, React, Redux, MongoDB, AWS S3, Docker* Oct 2025 – Oct 2025

- Built a full-stack Spotify-like music platform with a RESTful API backend and a React frontend.
- Developed the backend using Node.js, Express, and TypeScript with full CRUD operations for song and playlist management.
- Integrated AWS S3 for production file storage and local storage fallback for development.
- Managed frontend state with Redux and Redux Saga for asynchronous side effects including playback, playlists, and statistics.
- Built a statistics dashboard with artist and genre charts for visualizing the music library.
- Containerized the full development environment using Docker and Docker Compose.
- Deployed the frontend on Vercel and the API on Render — [araray.vercel.app](#) | [araray.onrender.com](#).

Drivee | *Golang, Vue.js, PostgreSQL, Docker, Memcached, TailwindCSS* May 2025 – Present

- Building a peer-to-peer car rental platform where users can list and rent vehicles.
- Developed the backend using Go's `net/http` for REST APIs.
- Created the frontend with Vue.js, using TailwindCSS, without any external UI libraries.
- Added Google and Twitter (X) SSO for login and user data access.
- Used Memcached to speed up response times by caching frequent API data.

Eagle Commerce | *Golang, NATS, MongoDB, Docker, Microservices* Jul 2025 – Jul 2025

- Designed and developed a distributed e-commerce backend using Hexagonal Architecture. The system consisted of `order-ms`, `payment-ms`, `product-ms`, `user-ms`, and an `api-gateway`.

- Implemented RESTful APIs using **Go-Chi** across all services.
- Utilized **NATS** for asynchronous, event-driven communication between services.
- Built a robust API Gateway to proxy requests to services and enforce rate limiting.
- Leveraged **MongoDB** for efficient document-based data storage across services.

Werewolf Game Bot | *Go, PostgreSQL, Docker, Event-Driven Architecture, Pub/Sub* Aug 2025 – Present

- Engineered a feature-rich Telegram bot in Go, used by multiple active groups to play the game of Werewolf. The bot leverages a sophisticated state machine to manage the entire game lifecycle, including complex phases, roles, and player actions.
- Architected the application using Clean Architecture principles and a custom Pub/Sub event broker to create a decoupled, concurrent, and maintainable codebase.
- Authored a public blog post detailing the design and implementation of the event-driven model. [blog](#).
- Drove a 4x reduction in hosting costs by analyzing performance and optimizing server resource allocation.
- Integrated PostgreSQL for persistent data storage, using *goose* for schema management and *sqlc* to generate type-safe Go code from raw SQL, improving reliability and developer productivity.

Foodopia | *Nuxt.js, Golang, PostgreSQL, Hasura, Apollo GraphQL, Docker, Flowbite* Jun 2024 – Jul 2024

- Built a recipe-sharing platform with user authentication, recipe creation, editing, filtering, and bookmarking.
- Used Hasura as the GraphQL engine and Gin (Go) for custom webhook handlers with a PostgreSQL database.
- Developed the frontend using Nuxt.js with Flowbite as the UI component library.

Pong | *Golang, Go-Raylib*

Mar 2025 – Mar 2025

- Built a multiplayer Pong game over LAN.
- Developed the client side using Go-Raylib, a Go binding for the Raylib game library.
- Created the server side with Golang and handled game state synchronization using UDP.

Audiobook Downloader Bot | *Grammy.js, TypeScript, JSDOM*

Aug 2024

- Built a Telegram bot that downloads audiobooks by scraping search results from the web.
- Implemented inline keyboard interactions using Grammy.js and TypeScript.
- Built a web scraper using JSDOM and the Fetch API to extract audiobook links from search results.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Go, Typescript, Javascript, SQL (Postgres), Python, Lua, C/C++, HTML/CSS

Frameworks: Vue, React, Nuxt, Next, Gin, Echo, Hugo, Node.js, TailwindCSS, headless-UI, Shadcn/ui, flowbite

Developer Tools: Git, Docker, Neovim, Linux, Nix, VS Code

Technologies: Kafka, NATS, RabbitMQ, GraphQL, PostgreSQL, SQLite, MongoDB, Redis, Memcached